base, enhancing their skill sets, or leveraging online platforms.

There are many benefits of running a business from one's home, especially for women entrepreneurs. It cuts down on logistical issues, including real estate negotiations for an office/ production space. Concerns of security and mobility, which often act as a deterrent both for women and their families, are negated. There are cost benefits, too, allowing a fledgling business to save on operational expenses. When Indore-based Surabhi Shah started her ecofriendly packaging solutions company Carragreen—conceptualised in the Indian Institute of Management (IIM) Bangalore's start-up incubator NSRCEL—in 2018, it was a bootstrapped business, recalls the entrepreneur. She chose to operate from her residence, turning a spare room in her house into an office space, preferring to invest the entire grant money of Rs 4.5 lakh received from IIM Bangalore into product development and customer acquisition. Mumbai-based Hansika Chandiramani, founder of HC Media—a company offering artist management, influencer marketing and video production services—realised the pros of home-based operations during the Covid pandemic. The company had operated out of a separate office space for the first five years, but when lockdown forced her and her team to go into WFH (work-from-home) mode, "We realised that productivity levels were higher because people were not wasting time stuck in Mumbai traffic and could even finish work earlier," Chandiramani says. There was also a tangible cost benefit—the nearly Rs 85,000 she was saving in rent added to the company's growth. Sudha Jha, senior manager at the Global Alliance for Mass Entrepreneurship (GAME), outlines an additional benefit of running their businesses from their homes—it enables them to be on top of their "lady of the house/ mom duties", even as they fulfill their professional aspirations. While Carragreen now has a separate office, Surabhi and her mother-in-law and the company's co-founder, Chetna Shah, continue to take turns to work from their home office, so that Surabhi can attend to her toddler.



"Women are the best asset class and best borrowers, with the lowest NPAs. Yet they still find it difficult to access loans through mainstream avenues"

– NEHA JUNEJA, *CEO, IndiaP2P*



ARUN SAHA

- Company: **RESHMONA Pharmaceuticals**
- Founder: **Mona Pandit**
- When: **2019**
- Where: **Pune**
- Business: **Ayurvedic skin care brand**
- FY 2023 turnover: **₹11.49 lakh**

» THE WIND BENEATH THEIR WINGS

It was Pune resident Mona Pandit's Ayurvedic doctor father, Dr Satish D. Pandit, who was the original founder of Ayurveda-based skincare brand RESHMONA Pharmaceuticals. Founded in 1984, the company was then known as Datsons Laboratories, but its reach was limited and it eventually closed down owing to partnership